



THE EGYPTIAN • WESTERN DESERT

08

The Grand Expedition

*Abu Moharek, the longest chain of dunes in the world,
from Baharia to Kharga*

A journey you can picture yourself inside

A journey down the longest chain of dunes in the world, criss-crossing labyrinths and travelling ancient camel routes, WW2 British tracks and Dakar Rally tracks. From lush oasis with palms, olives and mango groves to dunes, hills, escarpments, marble labyrinths and Mars-like terrain among the White Desert formations, finishing at the desert forts of Kharga.

The eighth of nine. It sits between the twelve-day Oasis Tour and the twenty-day Extensive crossing: deeper into Abu Moharek than the first, five days shorter than the second.

THE NINE, BY LENGTH IN DAYS

01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08	09
3	4	4	5	7	12	12	15	20

SHORTEST

EACH IS BOOKED ON ITS OWN

DEEPEST

HOW YOU TRAVEL

Vehicle · Deep desert camping. Cairo to Cairo or Luxor · 15 days · 4 to 20 travellers. Each of the nine journeys is a separate booking with its own start and finish; none is a stage of another.

IMPORTANT

This is the intended route, not a fixed timetable.

It communicates the ground covered, the pace and the level of effort. Named properties, exact camp locations, departure times, prices and meal inclusions are confirmed at booking. Weather, park authorities, soft sand and vehicle recovery can change the order or content of a day; this guide names those dependencies wherever they affect your choice.

Every day carries the same four facts

ROUTE

Where the day starts, what it passes through and where it ends.

SLEEP

Tent or bed, and where. Camps are chosen on the day; the area is fixed, the exact spot is not.

DISTANCE

Kilometres where the source gives them, on foot for the walking tours, otherwise an estimate.

MEALS

What is included that day. Anything not listed is not included.

RHYTHM

A reading of how much the day asks of you, followed by the kind of ground it crosses.

■ Easy

Road transfer, an oasis day, or a short walk. Recoverable.

■ Steady

A full day of driving or walking, with stops. The normal shape.

■ Demanding

Long hours, soft sand, recovery work or a hard walk. Plan around it.

FREE TIME

Noted where a day holds unstructured hours. Desert days rarely do; the group moves together and the camp is made together.

The Grand Expedition

NIGHTS CAMPING	10 per the tour description · 12 per the day list
NIGHTS IN LODGES	4 per the description · 2 per the costing (nights 1 and 14)
OFF-ROAD DISTANCE	≈1,200 km in Landcruisers
GROUND COVERED	Abu Moharek · Djara Cave · Agabat · Ein El Serw · White Desert · Karaween · Wadi Jahanam · Darb Al Tawil · Labakha Fortress · Um El Dabadeeb · Kharga

HOW THE DAYS GROUP

Baharia to Abu Moharek	Days 1–4
The valleys and the White Desert	Days 5–8
Wadi Jahanam and the Labyrinth	Days 9–11
The forts and Kharga	Days 12–15

DRAFTED, NOT CONFIRMED

Days 2 to 15 are drafted from the matching passages of the twenty-day Extensive itinerary and from the route line supplied. Every day on this spread needs your confirmation before the guide is issued.

01

Cairo — Baharia Oasis

ROUTE

Cairo → Baharia Oasis → English
Mountain → the Lakes → palm groves

SLEEP

Eco-Lodge · Baharia

DISTANCE

≈370 km road

MEALS

Lunch, dinner

EASY · ROAD AND OASIS

An 0800 start from Cairo, check-in at the eco-lodge, lunch, and a tour of the oasis: the English Mountain, the lakes, the dense palm groves and the slow pace of oasis life.

02

Baharia — Abu Shaala — Abu Moharek

ROUTE

Baharia Oasis → Abu Shaala → Abu
Moharek Dunes

SLEEP

Camp · Abu Moharek

DISTANCE

Draft — to confirm

MEALS

Breakfast, lunch,
dinner

STEADY · DUNE

DRAFT

The oasis is left behind on the first full off-road day, running east to Abu Shaala and then onto Abu Moharek, Egypt’s longest chain of dunes, where the first desert camp is made.

03 East Moharek and back

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Abu Moharek East → Abu Moharek	Camp · Abu Moharek	Draft — to confirm	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ DEMANDING · DUNE DRAFT

A day inside the chain, criss-crossing the dunes and driving the middle of the ridges. Fulgurites, old pottery, ostrich egg shell and the occasional ancient fuel tin surface where the wind has moved.

04 Abu Moharek — Djara Cave — Single Dune

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Abu Moharek → fuel stop → Djara Cave → Single Dune	Camp · Single Dune	Draft — to confirm	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · CAVE AND DUNE DRAFT

Out to the road to refuel, then the Djara Cave — North Africa’s largest stalactite and stalagmite cave, with cave-man rock art most visitors walk past. Back onto the sand afterwards to camp at the Single Dune.

05 Single Dune — Water-melon Valley — McMallan

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Single Dune → Water-melon Valley → McMallan	Camp · McMallan	Draft — to confirm	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · REMOTE **DRAFT**

West through the Water-melon Valley, named for the concretions that litter its floor, and on to McMallan for the night.

06 McMallan — Agabat — Serw — Matar

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
McMallan → Agabat → Ein El Serw → El Matar	Camp · El Matar	Draft — to confirm	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · OFF-ROAD **DRAFT**

Into the chalk of Agabat, then the Roman well at Ein El Serw, which still produces fresh water and where the group can wash. Camp is made in the white hill labyrinth of El Matar.

07

Matar — the Wadi — White Desert

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
El Matar → the Wadi → Ein Khadra → El Santa → White Desert	Camp · White Desert National Park	Draft — to confirm	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · OFF-ROAD DRAFT

Down through the valley to the second Roman well at Ein Khadra, then El Santa, the 2,000-year-old acacia, before entering the White Desert National Park and camping among the formations.

08

White Desert — Karaween — Abu Garara

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
White Desert → English Track → Karaween Dunes → Abu Garara Hill	Camp · Abu Garara Hill	Draft — to confirm	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · DUNE DRAFT

An early walk among the formations before the drive out east on the English Track, then open sand into the Karaween dunes and on to camp below Abu Garara Hill.

09 Abu Garara — Wadi Jahanam

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Abu Garara Hill → Dakhla dune chains → Wadi Jahanam	Camp · Wadi Jahanam	Draft — to confirm	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ DEMANDING · DUNE DRAFT

Crossing the parallel chains of the Dakhla dunes — sometimes easy, sometimes not — to Wadi Jahanam, Hell’s Valley, known for its scattered acacias and, with luck, dorcas gazelles.

10 Wadi Jahanam — Tawil — Abu Moharek Labyrinth

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Wadi Jahanam → Darb Al Tawil camel route → Abu Moharek Labyrinth	Camp · Abu Moharek Labyrinth	Draft — to confirm	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · REMOTE DRAFT

The Darb Al Tawil once carried camel caravans from Dakhla to the Nile valley, and carried the Rally of the Pharaohs in the early nineties. The day ends in the labyrinth at the edge of Abu Moharek.

11 Abu Moharek Labyrinth — Crescent Dunes

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Abu Moharek Labyrinth → Madman's Pass → Crescent Dunes	Camp · Crescent Dunes	Draft — to confirm	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ DEMANDING · DUNE DRAFT

Through Madman's Pass and into the crescents, where softer sand means a greater chance of getting stuck and, by common agreement, a better day.

12 Crescent Dunes — Labakha Fortress — Cathedral Dunes

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Crescent Dunes → Labakha Fortress and Well → Cathedral Dunes	Camp · Cathedral Dunes	Draft — to confirm	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · REMOTE DRAFT

The Roman fortress and well at Labakha stand at the northern edge of Kharga, on the caravan road that supplied it. Camp is made at the Cathedral dunes.

13 Cathedral Dunes — Um El Dabadeeb Fort

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Cathedral Dunes → Um El Dabadeeb Fort	Camp · Um El Dabadeeb	Draft — to confirm	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · REMOTE DRAFT

To Um El Dabadeeb, a Roman fort and settlement with its underground aqueducts still traceable in the ground. The last desert camp of the expedition.

14 Um El Dabadeeb — El Kharga Oasis

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Um El Dabadeeb Fort → El Kharga Oasis	Eco-Lodge · Kharga	Draft — to confirm	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · OASIS DRAFT

Out of the desert into Kharga and the eco-lodge — the first bed since night one, on the costing as written.

15

Kharga — Cairo or Luxor

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Kharga → Cairo, or Kharga → Luxor	—	Long road day	Breakfast, lunch

■ STEADY · RETURN

DRAFT

The drive out. Both destinations are available and the group chooses one at booking.

What the price carries, and what it does not

INCLUDED
Assembly pickup and drop-off at an agreed Cairo location
Eco-lodge accommodation for 2 nights (nights 1 and 14)
Transport in reliable Toyota Landcruisers for the entire off-road journey — 1,200 km
All meals listed in the itinerary
Drinks, snacks and fruit — water, tea, coffee, mint
Desert gear: kitchen, camping and recovery equipment
Tents, sleeping mats, sleeping bags and blankets
A friendly, English-speaking, experienced guide and a cook for the journey

NOT INCLUDED
White Desert National Park, temple and site tickets or entry fees
Personal expenses
Travel and medical insurance
Alcoholic beverages
Tips and gratuities

RATES

Priced on enquiry.

The source itinerary publishes no rate card. Every one of these journeys is quoted against the group — its size, its dates and any tailoring — so the figure is set on enquiry. This panel is reserved for the rate line and the deposit terms once you supply them.

Where this journey asks more of you

The lodging count does not agree in the source: the tour description says ten nights camping and four in lodges, the costing says eco-lodge for nights 1 and 14 only. This must be settled before the guide is issued.

Days 2 to 15 are drafted, not confirmed. The route line is yours; the day text is written from the parallel twenty-day itinerary.

Twelve or more consecutive nights in the deep desert with no resupply and no services. This is the second-most committing tour on the list.

Day 15 ends in Cairo or Luxor. Both are available; the group chooses one.

Active November to April. Groups of 4 to 20.

SEASON

Active November to April. Outside that window the heat makes the deep desert unworkable.

PHYSICAL DEMAND

Minimum endurance to walk the sites, the temples and the desert hikes, and to sit long hours in a vehicle over rough ground.

GROUP

4 to 20 travellers. Departures are private to the group.

VEHICLES AND GEAR

Toyota Landcruisers, stocked with supplies, kitchen, camping and recovery gear. Tents, mats, sleeping bags and blankets are provided.

TAILORING

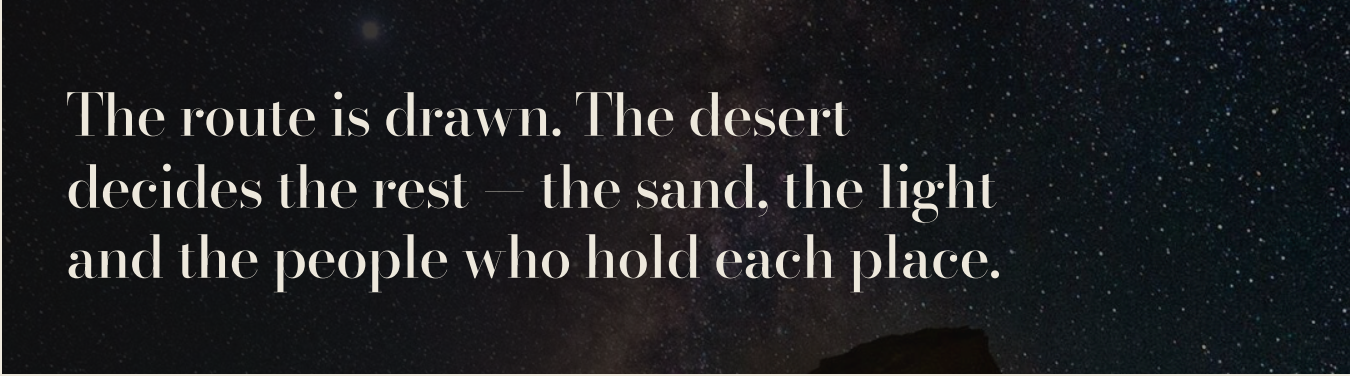
This journey can be tailored for a specific number of travellers, and the day order can be adjusted around your dates. Contact us for an offer.

From this guide to a confirmed departure

- | | | |
|----|---------------------------------------|--|
| 01 | Tell us the shape of the group | Numbers, dates in the November-to-April window, and anything the itinerary should bend around — age, mobility, diet, or a date that matters. |
| 02 | Receive the offer | A quoted price against that group, with the lodges named, the vehicles counted and the inclusions fixed against this itinerary. |
| 03 | Confirm and prepare | A kit list, park ticket costs, insurance requirements and the final day plan follow confirmation. |
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ENQUIRIES

This journey can be tailored for a specific number of travellers. Contact us for an offer against your own dates.



The route is drawn. The desert
decides the rest — the sand, the light
and the people who hold each place.